

Hindustani classical music. MusicalNirvana.com gives you all the insight you need into the basics of *raag* and *ghazals*. It gets into the nitty-gritty of all you need to know about the history of these two forms of melody. The instruments section lists all the instruments used, with links to the artists accomplished in that sphere.

Cybersangeet.com does a good job of profiling artistes who've given their heart and soul to Indian classical music. It gives a detailed account of the likes of vocalist Mitali Banerjee Bhawmik, sitar player Joya Biswas, tabla player Subrata Gupta and their work in its Profile section. **Surdhwani.com** talks about the lives of Pandit Bhimsen Joshi, Ustad Bismillah Khan, and a number of members of the classical ilk in its Artists section. Its Indian Classical section, with its *Tal*, *Raag* and Vocal sub-topics does not frighten you from delving into the intricacies of it all.

Get to know what Indian classical music is through the eyes of the maestro himself—Pandit Ravi Shankar, at his Web site, www.ravishankar.org. His appreciation of Indian classical music highlights the finer nuances of the entire genre.

Pandit ShivKumar Sharma's site (www.santoor.com) profiles the acclaimed *santoorist* in detail. It also lists his releases, and also reviews them with short clips from releases to complete the picture.

Ustad Amjad Ali Khan, the acclaimed *sarod* player, who likes to call himself "a slave to" (rather than "a king of") the *sarod*, bares his love for the instrument at www.sarod.com. The Web site also chronicles important events in his life, and also lets you in on his family tree. It mentions the Sarod Museum called the Sarod Ghar, located at Gwalior, that endeavours to preserve the traditions of Indian classical music.



"There is no essential difference between classical and popular music. Music is music." - Ustad Amjad Ali Khan



"Beethoven can write music, thank God, but he can do nothing else on Earth" - Ludwig Van Beethoven

Go West...

Essentials of Music (www.essentialsofmusic.com) is a Web site that will surely delight the western classical music lover. Whether it's Bach or Beethoven, each has been covered in just the right amount of detail—a few of their works are posted on the biography page to give a feel for their compositions. Its Eras section dissects the evolution that came about in compositional styles with time.

Another such Web site is Classical Net (www.classical.net). It lists information about when classical composers were born, the day they died, etc. There are also exhaustive links to other Web sites that provide detailed information about composers. The reviews and articles posted are concise.

If you want to get to know the people behind jazz, then All About Jazz (<http://www.allaboutjazz.com/library/index.htm>) is where you need to go. Learn all about Ella Fitzgerald, the first lady of song, Gene Harris, Tony Bennet, etc. Learn about the

albums that made them, and this peculiar, yet delightful, kind of music that originated in New Orleans. Louis Armstrong has a special profile page dedicated to him in Profiles. Another interesting Jazz Web site is www.thejazzfiles.com, which digs out interesting facts about the lives of tenor saxophonists Gene Ammons, Johnny Griffin, and pianists Sonny Clark among others.

Rock and Roll? Get the low-down on its highs and lows at www.history-of-rock.com. It swamps you with all the things that happened during the period (1954—1963) when rock and roll took shape, and came into existence as a unique genre of music. Oldies Music (<http://www.oldiesmusic.com>) tracks the sound right down to the '70s. One of its sections—the Oldies Calendar—tells you all about deaths, births and other ground-breaking events that took place in the current week. Its Oldies Artists sections has links to Web sites dedicated to musicians and pop artists that made rock and roll happen.

Though it sounds like the din in a railway accident, metal music has a dedicated fan following all over the world. If you'd



This band displaced the stranglehold of Iron Maiden on hard rock. More of this at <http://www.hardradio.com/history/part1.html>

Oh This? Just Something I Composed...

Have you always wanted to say that? Well, now you can! ACID PRO 4.0, available at <http://mediasoftware.sonypictures.com/products/acidfamily.asp> lets you synthesise your own music with a number of effects to boot.

It lets you have a dramatic fade between tracks, so that they don't sound like cut-paste jobs. It also lets you use as many loops and MIDI tracks as you like. ACID is bundled with 20 DirectX plugins such as amplitude modulation, delay, etc.

Fruity Loops studio (www.fruityloops.com) is another one you should try out. It has nearly 30 high quality effects thrown in for better mixing results. Its inbuilt wave editor lets you edit and record wave files. The editor also lets you reverse the track, add loop points to the file, or record yourself.

Apart from that Fruity Bass Boost, Fruity Stereo Enhancer and Fruity Blood Overdrive are some of the cool sound effects that really add the professional touch to your compositions.